Get Your Father's Daily Care Needs on Paper Before the Team Meeting

Four prompts to turn the requests you've been making out loud into written notes, separate instructions from wishes, spot the questions nobody has closed, and prepare for the care-team meeting.

Where you are

Your father's care has already started, and you've been asking the staff for things in passing: a hand at breakfast, the cream for his heels, someone to check his pills. Some of it happens. A care-team meeting is coming and you want to arrive with more than a list in your head.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can hand the team one page that shows the daily help your father needs as you see it, what instructions already exist and who gave them, what he prefers, and what still needs a professional's answer.

A one-page set of family notes for the team meeting with four headings: Daily help as we see it, Instructions already in place and their source, your father's preferences, and Questions for the team.

Before you start

- Anything written that came with your father's care: a discharge summary, a medication list, a therapist's sheet.
- Your memory of what you've asked staff for, and roughly when.
- A few lines on what your father says he wants. You don't need all of it to begin.

PROMPT 1

Put your spoken requests in writing

WHY THIS MATTERS

A request made at the nurses' station on a Tuesday afternoon lives in one person's memory. If that person is off on Thursday, so is the request.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your recollection of what you've asked for, who you told, and what happened.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My father is receiving care and I've been asking the staff for things verbally. Here is everything I can remember asking for, who I said it to, and what happened afterward:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Put this into a table with four columns: WHAT WE ASKED FOR, WHO WE TOLD AND WHEN, WHAT HAPPENED, and IS IT WRITTEN DOWN ANYWHERE. Where I didn't say whether something was written down, put a question mark rather than guessing. Then list the requests that seem to have gone nowhere, so I know which ones to raise again.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Requests that only ever existed in conversation.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the care home or agency where family requests are supposed to be recorded, and whether yours are.

PROMPT 2

Separate instructions from wishes

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your father liking his tea before his wash is a preference. The physiotherapist's note about how he transfers from bed is an instruction. On one page they look the same, and staff can't tell which is which unless you do.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Whatever written instructions you have, plus your notes on what your father prefers.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the written instructions I have for my father's care, copied as they appear, and my own notes about what he prefers:
>
> [PASTE INSTRUCTIONS AND NOTES]
>
> Sort everything into three lists. PROFESSIONAL INSTRUCTIONS: each one copied word for word, with who gave it and the date if I included them, or SOURCE UNKNOWN if I didn't. DAD'S PREFERENCES: things he likes or wants, in his words where I gave them. NOT SURE WHICH: anything you can't place. Do not reword, shorten, or add to any medication, diet, or therapy instruction, and do not suggest changes to any of them.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Instructions with no source, and preferences you've been presenting as if they were orders.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

For every SOURCE UNKNOWN item, find out who gave it, or move it to the questions list.

PROMPT 3

Find the questions still hanging

WHY THIS MATTERS

Someone said they'd look at your father's medications after the hospital. Someone mentioned a swallowing check. You assumed it happened. Assumptions like these are the gaps a care-team meeting exists to close, but only if you bring them.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The three lists from the last prompt, plus anything you remember being promised.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've sorted about my father's daily care, and some things I remember professionals saying they would look into:
>
> [PASTE THE LISTS FROM PROMPT 2 AND YOUR NOTES]
>
> Based only on this, list the questions that appear to be unresolved: anything promised but not confirmed, anything with no source, anything about medications, swallowing, food texture, skin, therapy, or equipment that nobody has clearly answered. Write each as a plain question. Beside each, name who would be the right person to answer it: doctor, nurse, pharmacist, therapist, care manager, or care consultant. Leave the questions unanswered.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The question you were sure someone else had handled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Call about the one that affects your father today. Save the rest for the meeting.

PROMPT 4

Write the page you'll bring to the meeting

WHY THIS MATTERS

The team will have their own plan. What they won't have is your view of your father's day, kept apart from their orders and clearly marked as notes for discussion. That page is what you're building.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Below is all of it, from the first three prompts, about my father's daily care:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write one page with four headings: DAILY HELP DAD NEEDS, AS WE SEE IT; INSTRUCTIONS ALREADY IN PLACE, WITH THEIR SOURCE; DAD'S PREFERENCES; and QUESTIONS FOR THE TEAM. Keep instructions exactly as I wrote them. Keep preferences in the preferences section even if they feel important. At the top put: Family notes for discussion, not a care plan, with today's date and my name as the author. Do not propose treatment, medication, or diet changes, and do not fill in anything I haven't given you.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page where a nurse could tell at a glance what is an order, what is a wish, and what is a question.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Print two copies. One for the meeting, one to mark up as the team answers.

Start with the whole picture

Your notes cover the daily care you've seen. The care interview asks about every part of your father's situation, including the parts a care meeting rarely reaches, and turns the answers into a Family Care Profile that the care-plan proposal is built from.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›